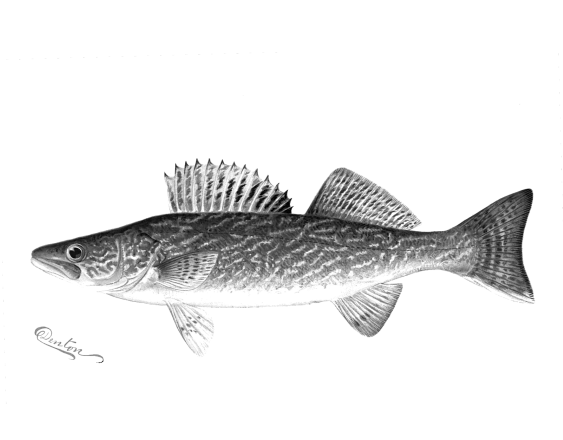


Walleye

Sander vitreus

The low-light specialist — Pine Lake & North Lake



The Pike Perch or Wall-Eyed Pike — chromolithograph by S. F. Denton, New York Commissioners of Fisheries, Game and Forests, 1896–1902. Public domain; converted to grayscale for printing.

Tell it apart

Not a sauger

Size here

Spawn

A white tip on the lower lobe of the tail and a dark blotch at the rear base of the spiny dorsal fin. The eye is large and glassy — a reflective layer behind the retina lets it see in water too dark for its prey. Long canine teeth.

Sauger have rows of black spots on the spiny dorsal, dark saddles, and no white tail tip. Not expected here, but worth knowing.

15–22 in. The 18 in minimum means most fish you catch go back. State record 18 lb.

Earliest of the gamefish after pike: 42–50 °F, late March into April, over rock and gravel shorelines and in inflows. Pine Lake is stocked with large fingerlings in alternate years.

Season

Time of day

JFMA MJJJASOND

DawnMidDuskNight

Where

Pine	Spots 3 (east wall), 4 (the bar) and 8 . In high summer they may suspend over the basin following cisco — do not assume they are on the bottom.
North	Spots 3 , 4 (south-end shoals) and 5 (the neck). Stained water means they will be shallower than on Pine.
Depth	The 18–30 ft break most of the year. Shallower at dawn, dusk and after dark; deeper in bright calm.
Weather	Grey and windy is a walleye day. Wind on a point breaks up the light and pushes bait against structure — fish the windy side.

How

Classic	Lindy rig with a leech, half a crawler, or a small minnow, dragged slowly along the contour, <i>see the lindy rig sheet</i> . Slow means slower than you think.
Cold water	Jig-and-minnow, <i>see the jig-and-minnow sheet</i> , worked with tiny lifts. Most bites feel like weight, not a strike.
Covering water	Troll a deep crankbait along the break. Motor trolling is allowed here, up to three hooks, baits or lures per angler.
Steep faces	A three-way rig holds a precise depth where a lindy rig will not, <i>see the three-way rig sheet</i> .
Timing	The last forty minutes of light beat the rest of the day. Be on the spot before the sun goes.

The one thing to remember

Walleye are not hard to catch; they are hard to be present for. Their eyes give them an advantage in dim light, so they feed when you would rather be at the landing. Fish the edges of the day.

Regulations on these waters, 2026–27. 18 in minimum, 3 per day, open 2 May–7 March. *These change; only the Wisconsin DNR’s current publication for this exact water body is authoritative.*

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